

Reviewed by: Sreelaxmi Nair (26/10/2023)

Title: War on Terror

Informative Details:

Trailer Link: <https://vimeo.com/867250011>

Screener Link:

Password:

IMDB Link:

https://www.imdb.com/title/tt21217688/?ref_=nv_sr_srg_3_tt_8_nm_0_q_war%2520on%2520terror

IMDB Rating: Yet to release on **23 November 2023**

Genre: Action, Crime, Thriller

Synopsis: Khalid, a rebellious cop from an elite special force must prove he is able to work as a team in order to thwart terrorist threats to bring down Kuala Lumpur.

Language: Malay, English Subs

Year of Release: 23 November 2023

Film Review

Overall feel of the film:

The film has us on an adrenaline rush. The story escalates gradually that helps the viewers to slowly sink in every scene and understand where the ride headed to. The film has good characters and the ones that are actually necessary. No character seems like an outcast.

The film has a protagonist who is rebellious and then a side character to balance it. The story flows very smoothly and has a good chronology of events except for a place at 44:00 to 48:31

Rest the movie has a good impact especially for the audiences who have seen such events happen in front of them.

Production Value:

The production is rich as the film has used enough equipment in the action sequences. The film has scenes of bombardment, shootings, car explosions, rope ways, etc. It also is made very realistically which can be seen with the number of people they have used in the film to show the crowd.

The Art Direction is also on point that has portrayed the hides of the terrorists.

Narrative:

The story is flowing in a smooth way and there are no unnecessary flashbacks or multiple POVs at a time to confuse the audience. The end credit scene that shows the main player in the whole plan was rightly set. Even though there is a protagonist, other characters are also given equal part in the whole story leaving no one behind.

Pace:

The film is well paced and escalates gradually maintaining its speed and that is what helps the story be in the mind. Time gap is given to the viewer to soak in every bit of the scenes before entering the next turn.

Location:

The locations are chosen wisely. The places that seem quite crowded and the mid city area are chosen to show bombardments, while the hiding places are selected where it may seem impossible for terrorists to attack. The shooting scenes were shot in daylight and in the corridors of a building that would make it look real.

Story:

The synopsis in IMDb can be misleading as the protagonist and life are not the very core of the film but the everyday life of a military officer and the people he is surrounded by while at work and the run to save the country.

The story is first thought to be very simple, but that is the very jist of it. Without the unnecessary over exaggeration of action scenes, it's kept real to align with the true events.

Characters:

The characters are wisely placed. There are no characters that would seem useless. Each character has their own struggles which is briefly shown as the film seems to be part 1 of the sequel.

Technical aspects like: Cinematography, Lighting, Sound, VFX, etc.

- The cinematography is quite on point. The shots are taken very systematically and make it seem real.
- The lighting is so accurate that the location even after being a simple place has the vibes that the frame of the film wants the viewer to feel.
- The sound quality is really good and has enough beats and BGM needed which keeps the audience interested.
- The VFX used to show bombardment is very accurate and makes it seem real. Especially the scene where Zack is tied up with a bomb and the blast looks very real.

Additional observations, if any:

The actors playing Joe seem to be over-acting but that is to show that they are psychopaths and don't bother killing innocent people.

At 44:00 to 48:31 where the villain seems to be captured and under their control in 44 mins but is out meeting his father at 48:31.

Why should we acquire this movie?

Yes, of course

Why should we acquire it even if it is old?

It's not old but yet to be released The film keeps the audience belted to seats till the very last to know the next move and understand the whole events. It is an amazing action thriller about the military and police in Malaysia and how they fight with the inborne terrorists and naxals.

Is the film already streaming on OTTs, if yes – Name of OTT, language / subtitles, etc.

No it's yet to release

Should we consider / buy or skip the film?

Must buy and it will be a good purchase considering the audience we have who like the action content